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Scottsdale mayor pushes for council review on Flock camera program

Police say the technology has helped solve crimes; some residents want it gone

Scottsdale is the latest Arizona city to take a closer look at license plate reader technology amid controversy over its use by cities and police departments.

By [Zach Prelutsky](#)

Published: Sep. 22, 2026 at 4:47 AM UTC | Updated: 10 hours ago



SCOTTSDALE, AZ (AZFamily) — Scottsdale is the latest Arizona city to take a closer look at license plate reader technology amid controversy over its use by cities and police departments.

Scottsdale Mayor Lisa Borowsky said she has recently heard from residents about the cameras.

“I would say overwhelmingly against,” Borowsky said.

Borowsky is asking the council to review the city’s use of Flock cameras. An item on [Tuesday’s Scottsdale City Council meeting](#) agenda could pave the way for further council action regarding the system.

“Our chief of police said, ‘Give me a chance to provide you with a memo, a complete summary of what we do in terms of checks and balances and ensuring that there is no abuse.’ And so he’s done that, and he did a great job. But I do think time is of the essence right now,” said Borowsky.

“If it was up to me, I would vote against it,” Matt Leprino said.

Leprino moved to Scottsdale earlier this summer, and while he’s only lived in the city for a few months, he’s heard plenty about the debate over Flock cameras.

“I think privacy is always the number one concern with it, right? So one half of my brain says if you’re not doing anything wrong, you know, what do you care? On the other half of me, if the data is not being protected and it’s not secure and it’s being misused for reasons, then it’s a huge problem,” Leprino said.

Flock cameras came to Scottsdale in 2023, and today there are 85 citywide, but Borowsky wants current council members to have a say in the program’s future.

“People elect us to make decisions that are policy-oriented, and I do think this is an issue for the Council to take up and decide on,” Borowsky said.

Scottsdale police say Flock cameras have proven to be an extraordinarily effective and legal tool

A department spokesperson shared several cases from the last couple of years with Arizona's Family in which ALPR technology has helped the department, ranging from murder investigations to human trafficking cases, noting how quickly the technology can work.

"License plate reader technology has become an incredibly valuable public safety and investigative tool for the Scottsdale Police Department. It allows our officers and detectives to take limited vehicle information and quickly turn it into actionable investigative leads. In a number of cases, it has helped us locate violent offenders, recover stolen vehicles, find vulnerable missing people, identify suspects, and intervene before additional crimes could occur. Our ALPR program is not a mass surveillance system and is not used in that way. It is subject to strict policies, retention limits, and oversight."

— *Scottsdale Police Public Information Officer Aaron Bolin*

Borowsky said she has concerns about the technology but is still undecided on how the city should move forward with Flock.

"I haven't decided yet, so I don't want to commit to my position. I do have my concerns and that's why I brought it forward and asked for a meeting as soon as possible," Borowsky said.

If passed, Tuesday's agenda item would put a presentation, discussion and possible action on the entire ALPR program on Scottsdale City Council's Oct. 20 meeting.

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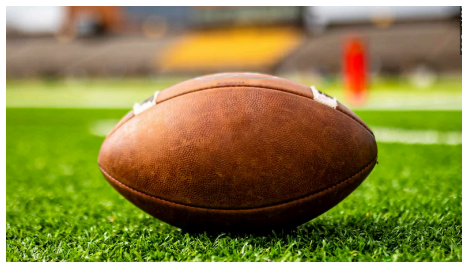
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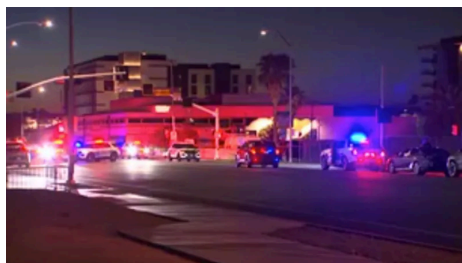
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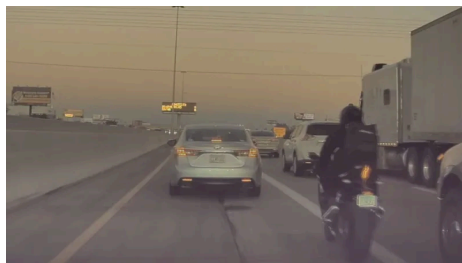
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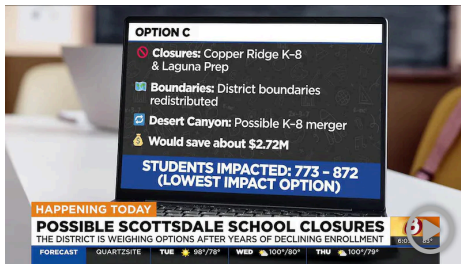
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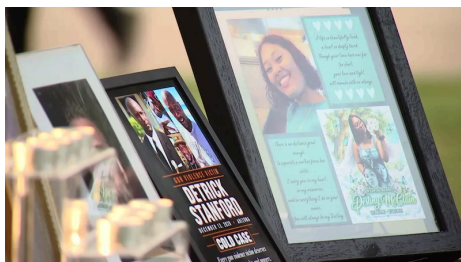
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